



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2023-24
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

General Instructions:

- The question paper consists of six printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.
- Reading time: 10 minutes
- Writing time is not included in the reading time

SECTION -A

Question 1

Choose and write the most appropriate option:

[1x10=10]

a) Both the players are not adequately prepared for the tournament. (*Begin: Neither...*)

- i. Neither this nor that player are adequately prepared for the tournament.
- ii. Neither of the players are adequately prepared for the tournament.
- iii. Neither of the two players is adequately prepared for the tournament.
- iv. Neither this player nor that player is adequately prepared for the tournament.

b) Some boys were helping the wounded man. (*Begin: The wounded.....*)

- i. The wounded man was helped by some boys.
- ii. The wounded boys were helping the man.
- iii. The wounded man was helping some boys.
- iv. The wounded man was being helped by some boys.

c) She is weak but courageous. (*Begin Despite....*)

- i. Despite being courageous, she is not weak.
- ii. Despite being weak, she is courageous.
- iii. Despite of being weak she is courageous.
- iv. Despite weak, she is courageous.

d) _____ she completed her assignment before everyone else even started? (*Choose the correct tense*)

- i. Hadn't
- ii. Didn't
- iii. Haven't
- iv. Did

e) I _____ (read) War and Peace for a month now. *(Fill in the blank with the present perfect continuous tense)*

- i. have being reading
- ii. is reading
- iii. have read
- iv. have been reading

f) We have warned you. *(Choose the correct voice)*

- i. We have you warned.
- ii. We have been warned you.
- iii. You have been warned by us.
- iv. You have being warned by us.

g) Choose the correct position of adverbs.

- i. He ran quickly after breakfast to the station to catch the train.
- ii. He quicky ran after breakfast to the station to catch the train.
- iii. He ran quickly to the station after breakfast to catch the train.
- iv. He ran after breakfast quickly to the station to catch the train.

h) Life is a journey, find your own way. *(Identify the figure of speech)*

- i. Simile
- ii. Irony
- iii. Metaphor
- iv. Personification

i) Choose the correct position of adverbs.

- i. Our parents are going to leave soon the house.
- ii. Our parents are soon going to leave the house.
- iii. Our parents are going soon to leave the house.
- iv. Our parents are soon to going leave the house.

j) The plan has potential but due to shortage of funds it has _____. *(Fill in the blank with a suitable phrasal verb)*

- i. looking up
- ii. come round
- iii. held up
- iv. fallen through

SECTION-B

Question 2

(Do not spend more than 30 minutes on this question.)

Write a composition (350-400 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- a) 'AI or Artificial Intelligence is killing creativity.' Express your views either for or against this statement.
- b) While you were waiting, at the railway station of your hometown, to receive a friend there was a sudden explosion. Describe the scene elaborately and also narrate your actions and feelings related to the incident.
- c) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 3

(Do not spend more than 20 minutes on this question.)

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- a) You attended a party when you were away on a vacation. On your return, your friends are eager to know how you spent your holidays. Tell them about someone you met at the party who appeared strange to you, bringing out his unusual characteristics and his odd personal appearance.
- b) You, along with your relatives, plan to visit a hill resort in summer after the examinations. Write a letter to the Director in Charge of the Indian Tourism Department of the hill station you plan to visit enquiring about the easiest route, availability and tariff for stay for three days as well as the interesting sites you should visit to make your summer trip meaningful.

Question 4

Write a Notice on the following topic.

[5]

Write a notice to be put up on the school notice board informing the students of classes VIII-XII about an Inter House Cultural Festival on the occasion of '*Azadi ka Amrit Mahotsav*'.

Question 5

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

A list of articles lost by railway travellers and now on sale at a great London station has been published and many people who have read it have been astonished at the absentmindedness of their fellows. If statistical records were available on the subject, however, I doubt whether it would be found that absentmindedness is common. It is the efficiency rather than the inefficiency of human memory that impels my wonder. Modern man remembers even telephone numbers, addresses of his friends, the dates of good vintages. He remembers appointments for lunch and dinner. His memory is crowded with the names of actors and actresses and cricketers and footballers and murderers. In his ordinary life, again, he remembers almost everything that he is expected to remember. How many men in all London forget a single item of their clothing when dressing in the morning? Not one in a hundred. How many of them forget to shut the front door when leaving the house? Scarcely anyone. And so it goes on through the day, almost everybody remembering to do the right thing at the right moment till it is time to go to bed and then the ordinary man seldom forgets to turn off the lights before going upstairs.

There are, it must be admitted, some matters regarding which man works with less than his usual perfection. It is only a very methodical man, I imagine. Who can always remember to take medicine his doctor has prescribed for him? This is more surprising because medicine should be one of the easiest things to remember. As a rule, it is supposed to be taken before, during or after meals, and the meal itself should be a reminder of it. The fact remains, however, that few but the moral giants remember to take their medicines regularly. Certain psychologists tell us that we forget things because we wish to forget them and it may be that it is because of their antipathy to pills and potions that many people fail to remember them at all the appointed hours.

The commonest form of forgetfulness, I suppose, occurs in matters of posting letters. Anyone who asks me to post a letter is a poor judge of character. Even if I carry the letter in my hand, I am always past the first pillar-box before I remember that I ought to have posted it. Weary of holding it in my hand, I then put it for safety into one of my pockets and forget about it.

As for leaving articles in trains and taxis, I am not a great delinquent in such matters. I can remember everything except books and walking-sticks. I can often even remember books. Walking-sticks, I find it quite impossible to keep. I dare not carry an umbrella for fear of losing it.

Few of us, however, have lost much property in our travels through forgetfulness. The ordinary man arrives at his destination with all his bags and trunks safe. The list of articles lost in trains during the year suggests that it is the young rather than the adults who forgets things and that sportsmen have worse memories than their ordinary serious-minded fellows. A considerable number of footballs and cricket bats were forgotten. This is easy to understand, for boys, returning from the games, have their imagination filled with the vision of the playing-field and their heads are among the stars- or their hearts in

their boots – as they recall their exploits or their errors. They are abstracted from the world outside.

(Robert Lynd)

a) Give the meaning of each of the following words as used in the passage. One word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [3]

- i. impels
- ii. antipathy
- iii. delinquent

b) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words:

- i. What instances of human memory efficiency in ordinary life wonder the writer? [3]
- ii. Quote the section from the passage which indicates that we decide things we like to forget. [1]
- iii. State what follows when the writer is asked to post a letter. [2]
- iv. What are the two things that Lynd is liable to forget most? [2]
- v. Give a suitable title for the above passage. [1]

c) In not more than 50 words state what the author has to share regarding losing properties during train journeys. [8]

Question 6

Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. [½ x 8=4]

Example: (0) returned.

After Christopher Columbus returned (0) from his famous voyage across the Atlantic, the King of Spain ____ (1) ____ (*wish*) to celebrate the great event and do honour to the man who ____ (2) ____ (*make*) himself a national hero. He ____ (3) ____ (*do*) so by holding a banquet in honour of the explorer. To this banquet he ____ (4) ____ (*invite*) many of the nobles of the King's Court. Some of them ____ (5) ____ (*be*) jealous of the success Columbus ____ (6) ____ (*achieve*). One of them sat next to Columbus. He turned towards Columbus and said, "Of course you ____ (7) ____ (*be*) a brave man but it doesn't take much intelligence to do what you have done. After all, anyone can take a ship and sail on and on till he ____ (8) ____ (*reach*) land."

Question 7

Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*. [1x4=4]

- a) Danny met me. I gave him the document.
- b) He is very poor. He helps others in need.
- c) The men went out to see if anyone was missing. The women stayed behind to care for the injured.
- d) A cottager and his wife had a hen. The hen laid an egg every day.

Question 8

Do as directed:

[7]

- a) She asked me to be quiet. *(Rewrite the sentence into direct speech)*
- b) May God bless you with success. *(Change the voice of the sentence)*
- c) My father said to me” Let us go to the club.” *(Change into indirect speech)*
- d) I will not answer any question now. *(Change the voice of the sentence)*
- e) I opened and read the letter. [they returned/quickly/before] *(Position the given units correctly)*
- f) She was unable to _____ her tears. *(Fill in the blank with a suitable phrasal verb)*
- g) I read sometimes a book before bed. *(Rewrite the sentence correctly)*